



Big strides: Anahat won the women's title at the recently concluded JSW Indian Open, while Egypt's Kareem El Torkey won the men's crown. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

because there's still quite some time left. We'll only know next year or in 2027, but it's probably going to be based on the rankings. Just to be safe, the top 20 should qualify and I'm 60 right now. I have a lot of work left to do.

It's also the main reason why I shifted from juniors to seniors because juniors isn't the aim in the long run — the Olympics is. The only way that's going to happen is if I'm top 20 in the world. Just playing these tournaments helps my ranking and helps me understand where my level is right now compared to all the seniors, and where I need to work so that I'm able to compete with them and get a medal as well in the next three years.

How have the tournaments at home helped you in your journey?

In March, there were two events — SRFI Indian Tour, Chennai, and JSW Indian Open, Mumbai. I was ranked around 80 prior to those tournaments and because I won both, I reached 60. I had my exams that ended a week before those two tournaments. If I had to play something internationally, it would have been really difficult and I

would have still been stuck at 80.

Being in India made it so much easier to board a flight, travel and play a tournament where I'm familiar with the crowd. It's a huge advantage playing in your home country rather than somewhere outside because of all the travel and the jet lag.

It all pays off in the performance as well. Those two tournaments were really important for me. I wouldn't have qualified for the World Championship if I hadn't won those two. I wouldn't have gone to play in the qualifiers either.

What are the major events for you for the rest of the season?

I have the World Championship right now and then I have the British Open qualifying (May 27-29), which is the biggest tournament after the World Championship. If I do qualify, the main draw starts just two days later.

Then I'm playing the Asian Doubles Championships (June 23-27) in Malaysia, the Asian Junior Championships (July 1-5 in Korea), and the World Junior Championships (July 21-August 1 in Egypt) as well over the summer.

RAPID FIRE



Which app do you use the most on your phone?
Snapchat

Which movie did you watch recently?
Anyone But You

One favourite dish that you can sacrifice for the rest of your life in exchange for an Olympic medal?
Sushi

One squash player whose style you really like or want to emulate?
World No. 3 Hania El Hammamy (Egypt)

If not a squash player, which profession would you have picked for yourself?
Badminton

Which song is always there on your practice playlist?
Hall of Fame by The Script